Laravel uses **Node.js** and **NPM** for managing frontend assets. You can install Node.js from the Node.js website, https://nodejs.org/. Select the LTS version for stability based on your system architecture (Windows, macOS, or Linux).

After installation, verify by running:

```
node -v
npm -v
```

If you have Node.js installed, NPM is included by default.

You can install the latest version of Node.js using a package manager like Homebrew (macOS) or Chocolatey (Windows).

1.6 Setting Up the Development Environment

Laravel is flexible with local development options. You can use:

- **Traditional setup** with PHP, MySQL, and Composer installed directly on your machine
- **Docker-based setup** using Laravel Sail for a containerized and portable environment

1.6.1 Composer, PHP, and MySQL Setup

For a traditional setup, make sure the following are installed:

Tool	Minimum Version
PHP	8.2 or higher
Composer	Latest version
MySQL	5.7+ or MariaDB 10.3+

You can verify with:

```
php -v
composer -V
mysql --version
```

Once installed: